

The Marshal



Hoping for peace isn't enough. Trouble always comes knocking. And that's why we need you: to run the drills, to man the towers, to take charge when things get bad. To be cold enough to send your neighbors to a sure death in order to keep Stonetop safe. That's the job, Marshal. You up for it?

Background (Choose 1)

☐ SCION

You grew up here, descended from a long line. Some of the biggest names in Stonetop's past are perched in your family tree. Everyone in the village takes your authority as a given, and your crew is a well-established institution in town.

You start with the Veteran Crew move, in addition to your usual moves. Go mark it now.

When you *create your Crew*, they automatically have the *respected* tag (in addition to your usual picks, and any you get from Veteran Crew).

☐ PENITENT

Before you came here, you led a band of ne'er-do-wells: bandits, raiders, or bloody-handed mercenaries. But something changed. A moment of truth led you and your followers—some of them at least—to leave that life behind. And for whatever reason, the people of Stonetop took you in.

When you *draw on your bloody past to Know Things*, you may roll +STR instead of +INT. If you do, the GM will ask you who you wronged back then or who might still hold a grudge. Answer them now.

When you *create your Crew*, they automatically have the *warriors* tag (in addition to your usual picks).

☐ LUMINARY

You're a natural leader—your words inspire, your plans win the day, your deeds are recounted far and wide. Are you touched by the gods? Does ancient blood flow in your veins? Or are you simply the champion that Stonetop needs in these trying times?

You start with the We Happy Few move, in addition to your usual moves. Go mark it now.

When you *create your Crew*, they automatically have the *devoted* tag (in addition to your usual picks).

Instinct (Choose 1)

☐ AUTHORITY

To take charge and throw your weight around.

☐ CAUTION

To keep everyone safe, to agonize over decisions.

☐ DRIVE

To take on ever more responsibility.

☐ HONOR

To keep your word, to follow a moral code.

☐ RUTHLESSNESS

To do whatever it takes to win or survive.

☐

Appearance

Choose 1 on each line, or make something up:

- ☐ upstart youth ☐ experienced & sober ☐ grizzled
☐ clear voice ☐ resonant voice ☐ rumbling voice
☐ stern frown ☐ grim-set jaw ☐ knowing smirk
☐ badge of office ☐ spit & polish ☐ timeworn gear

Place of origin and name

Stonetop is your home, or close enough, but where are you (or your family) from originally? Pick 1 and a name to match (or make up something similar).

- ☐ **Stonetop:** Bethan, Cadfael, Ffraid, Gwythyr, Llewelyn, Meredith, Rhianna, or Urien
☐ **Gordin's Delve:** Pick a name from any list
☐ **Marshedge:** Brigh, Cathal, Conn, Donal, Fionna, Laith, Talulla, or Torin
☐ **The Steplands** (Hillfolk): Adl, Aeln, Clotild, Judoc, Katrn, Mygl, Pirn, or Sera
☐ **The Manmarch:** Berkhard, Gerhild, Hartig, Hilde, Sabrinne, Ulrike, Urrola, or Weillein
☐ **Lygos or some other point south:** Ameer, Calixta, Hadar, Kelila, Sulaim, Ursa or Xandros

I am
called...

Stats Assign these scores: +2, +1, +1, +0, +0, -1. When a debility is marked, you roll with disadvantage.

Strength (STR)	Dexterity (DEX)	Intelligence (INT)	Wisdom (WIS)	Constitution (CON)	Charisma (CHA)
weakened		dazed		miserable	
d8 Damage	HP (max 20)	Armor	XP	Level	

Moves You start with Crew, Logistics, any moves from your Background, and 1 move of your choice.

☐ **ARMORED**

When you *carry a shield*, mark only ☞ (instead of ☞☞). Also, you can ignore the *cumbersome* tag on any armor you wear.

If you take this move at the start of play, add an
◇◇ iron hauberk, ◇◇ bronze cuirass, or
◇◇ scale coat to your inventory (all are 2 armor, *warm, cumbersome*).

☐ **ARTS OF WAR**

(Requires level 2+, the Marshal)

Take a move from the Fox, Heavy, Judge, Ranger, or Seeker playbooks, for which you otherwise qualify. You can pick from a different playbook each time. You can't take Improved Stat or Superior Stat.

☒ **CREW**

You've got a crew of stalwarts, six or so residents of Stonetop with some steel to them. See the Crew insert for details.

☐ **VETERAN CREW**

(Requires Crew)

Each time you take this move, pick 1. You can also choose to reselect their Instinct and Cost.

- ☐ Select 2 new tags for your Crew
- ☐ Increase their damage die from d6 to d8
- ☐ Increase their max HP by 2 each

☐ **FRONT LINE LEADER**

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When you *lead your crew into battle*, hold 2 Presence. Spend Presence in lieu of your crew's Loyalty or as Readiness (as if you Defended them).

☐ **IMPROVED STAT**

Each time you take this move, increase one of your stats by 1 (to a max of +2).

☒ **LOGISTICS**

When you *have a steading Muster or Pull Together*, or when you *Requisition*, you have advantage.

☐ **READ THE LAND**

When you *first take a moment to survey the terrain*, ask the GM one of the following; gain advantage on your next roll to act on the answer.

- ☞ What's the best way in, out, through, or past?
- ☞ Where's the best spot for a trap or an ambush?
- ☞ Where's the most defensible position?
- ☞ What here is out of place?

☐ **PREPARE A WELCOME**

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(Requires Read the Land)

When you *have your allies fortify a position and lie in wait for battle*, hold 1 Surprise if you're rushed or 2 Surprises if you can take your time.

Once battle is joined, spend 1 Surprise to reveal a ploy, defense, or dirty trick you prepared in advance and roll +INT: **on a 10+**, it works as well as can be expected, and you've still got a few tricks up your sleeve—regain 1 Surprise; **on a 7-9**, it works as well as can be expected.

☐ **SET-UP STRIKE**

When you *Clash and get a 7+*, you can choose to deal damage with disadvantage. If you do, you create an opening for ally to act on, as if you provided Aid. Describe it!

☐ **SHAKE IT OFF**

When you *order an ally to overcome fear, pain, doubt, or delusion*, roll +CHA: **on a 10+**, they do it; **on a 7-9**, a PC gets advantage to do it; an NPC will do it, but they'll need time, they'll resent you, or they'll feel humiliated (GM decides).

☐ **SHIELD WALL**

When you *have your crew form a shield wall*, they Defend with advantage and **on a 7+** they hold +2 Readiness (instead of the usual +1 for shields). *As long as they maintain formation*, they can go on the offensive without losing Readiness.

Special possessions (Pick 2)

- ☐ **Chirurgeon's tools:** catgut, straps, bandages, tubes, poultice, willow bark, ◇ bonesaws, etc.
- ☐ **Distillery:** skins of fine whisky (○○ uses, grants advantage to Persuade), copper tubes, malt, ◇◇ firkins, stills, barrels, etc.
- ☐ **Engineer's tools:** rulers, tapes, rods, plumb-bobs, ◇ tripods, ◇ block & tackles, wheelbarrow, etc.
- ☐ **Personal symbol** (a flag, crest, marking, etc.): when you *display or reveal it in a dramatic fashion*, your crew holds +1 Loyalty (max 3).
- ☐ **Scribe's tools:** parchment, ink, pigments, vials, quills, ◇ a notebook, etc.
- ☐ **Weapons of war:** choose up to 3 (now or later):
 - ☐ ◇ Sword, iron (*close*, +1 damage)
 - ☐ ◇◇ Long spear, fine steel (*reach*, 2 piercing)
 - ☐ ◇ Battleaxe, iron (*close, messy*)
 - ☐ ◇ Composite bow (*far*, +1 damage, x piercing; ○ low ammo, ○ all out)
- ☐ _____ (discuss with GM)

☐ SIR, PERMISSION TO DIE, SIR

When *one of your followers would die*, you can spend 1 of their Loyalty to have them survive (out of the action, but alive). If you let them go, mark XP.

☐ SPEAK SOFTLY

When you *offer peace but your enemy refuses*, gain advantage on your next roll against them.

☐ STENTORIAN

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When you *raise your voice*, it carries far and cuts through even the din of battle. When you *go into battle*, hold 2 Command. Spend 1 Command to shout an order or warning and pick 1:

- ⊗ PCs get advantage on their next roll to do as you say
- ⊗ You have advantage to Order Followers or Deploy

☐ TAKE THE MEASURE

When you *size someone up*, ask their player one of the questions below and get an honest answer. If they *fear or respect you* (their call), you can ask another question. You can't use this move on them again until your relationship significantly changes.

- ⊗ Can I trust them (to _____)?
- ⊗ What do they intend to do?
- ⊗ How are they most useful/dangerous?
- ⊗ What weakness of theirs can I exploit?

☐ WE HAPPY FEW

When you *give an inspiring speech to your allies before facing a dire threat*, roll +CHA: **on a 10+**, each ally holds 2 Inspiration; **on a 7-9**, each ally holds 1 Inspiration; **on a 6-**, each ally holds 1, but you have disadvantage on all rolls until you share your nagging doubts with someone else.

Once battle is joined, your allies can spend their Inspiration at any time, 1-for-1 to do the following:

- ⊗ Act fearlessly in the face of terror or overwhelming odds
- ⊗ Keep 1 HP instead of being reduced to 0 HP
- ⊗ Add 1d6 to a damage roll they just made

☐ BATTLEFIELD GRACE

(Requires level 6+ and Front Line Leader)

When you *take damage while leading your allies in battle*, the damage roll has disadvantage.

☐ HEROES TO THE LAST

(Requires level 6+ and Veteran Crew)

Each time you take this move, pick 1:

- ☐ They are *exceptional* (and roll +2 instead of +1)
- ☐ They are inured to terror & horror
- ☐ Increase their max HP by 4 each
- ☐ Increase their damage die one size (max d10)

☐ FOCUS FIRE

(Requires level 6+, Stentorian)

You can spend 1 Command to order your allies to bring down a foe. If you do, each ally has advantage on their next damage roll against that foe.

☐ LIKE AN OPEN BOOK

(Requires level 6+ and Take the Measure)

When you *Take the Measure of someone who fears or respects you*, your second question can be anything you want. The GM might ask how you could possibly know this; tell them or ask something else.

☐ NOBLE MIEN

(Requires level 6+)

When you *lead an NPC through danger and return them to safety*, if they aren't part of your crew they will either offer to join your crew or pledge their future aid and support.

☐ PEACE THROUGH STRENGTH

(Requires level 6+ and Speak Softly)

When you *stand ready to fight alongside like-minded allies*, anything capable of fear recognizes you as a serious threat and treats you accordingly.

☐ SUPERIOR STAT

(Requires level 6+)

Increase one of your stats by +1 (to a max of +3).

War stories

The last time the militia saw serious action, it was... (pick 1)

- ☐ ...to repel a nighttime raid by crinwin from the Great Wood.
- ☐ ...to drive off bandits who'd taken up near the Ruined Tower.
- ☐ ...to fend off Hillfolk pursuing a blood feud.
- ☐ ...against Brennan and his Claws, before they settled in Marshedge.
- ☐ ...to face a brutish hagr, come down from the Foothills to wreak havoc.
- ☐ ...to hunt down beasts (wolves, drakes, or bears maybe?) who'd been preying on the village.

Answer at least 3 of the following questions about that action:

- ☐ When exactly did it happen?
- ☐ Who lost their life, and who mourns them?
- ☐ Who from Stonetop was maimed, and how?
- ☐ Who saved the day, and how?
- ☐ How did the enemy get away, and whom do you still blame for it?
- ☐ Who comported themselves with honor?
- ☐ What's been bugging you about it ever since?
- ☐ What's got you even more worried now?

Introductions

Wait here for everyone else. When everyone's ready, take turns introducing your characters. When *someone reveals something and you want to know more*, ask them about it. When *someone asks you a question*, answer it truthfully.

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- 1** On your first turn, **introduce yourself** by name, pronouns, background, origin, and appearance.
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- 2** On your second turn, **describe your special possessions** and how you contribute to the village (beyond working the fields).
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- 3** On your third turn, **tell us the town's war stories**, plus the answers to the questions you chose.
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- 4** On your next turn, **answer one of the following**, naming one or more NPCs who live in Stonetop.
 - ☐ Who is your closest kin?
 - ☐ Who is your lover/spouse/betrothed?
 - ☐ Who is your lieutenant?
 - ☐ Whose kin is dead because of your decisions?
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- 5** Go around again. Answer another question from 4, or pass. When everyone has passed, go on.
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- 6** On your next turn, **ask your fellow PCs one of these**. When others ask you, answer as you like.
 - ☐ Which one of you is or was part of my crew?
 - ☐ Which one of you have I promised to keep safe?
 - ☐ Which one of you do I still have doubts about?
 - ☐ Which one of you ignored my orders and got someone killed?
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- 7** Go around again. Ask another question from 6, or pass. When everyone has passed, go on.
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- 8** Add your home to the steading playbook. When everyone is done, let spring break forth!